

Buying a business is hard work. We make it easier.

Whether it's your 1st or your 100th acquisition, we run the process for you — thesis, sourcing, diligence, close.

150

ACQUISITIONS

\$5B+

REVENUE ADDED

0

SELL-SIDE DEALS.
EVER.



Paul Baker

Buy-side corporate development

SWIPE →

THE PROBLEM

Building corp dev in-house runs \$500,000 to \$1,500,000 a year.

Most buyers do not have a corporate development function.
Standing one up is the expensive way to find that out.

- **All-in, not just salary** — and it is a fixed cost attached to an activity that only happens occasionally.
- **It does not scale down between deals.** The function is idle and the cost is not.
- **Most banks are built for the sell side.** A buy-side search is a different job.

Targets under \$250M revenue. Buy-side only – THE LINE, smbX practice perimeter.

THE ENGAGEMENT

smbXCorpDev

Thesis to close. The whole buy-side function, run for you.

- 1 **Thesis** — what to buy, and whether it is buyable today.
- 2 **Sourcing** — the owners who are not looking to sell, reached under your name.
- 3 **Evaluation** — financials rebuilt, every adjustment tested, surprises found early.
- 4 **Structure & offer** — terms a lender will back. We write it and we negotiate it.
- 5 **Diligence & close** — where deals come apart. Every thread held to signing.

One buyer per target. Never the sell side – it is in the engagement letter.

THE UPGRADE

smbXCorpDev Premium

Everything above. Then the part most advisors skip.

- 6 **Integration** — the first hundred days, planned before close. You keep the people and the customers you just paid for.
- 7 **Value creation** — we stay past day 100: the thesis tracked, the levers pulled, the add-ons sourced.

Premium is the same team staying in the deal after the wire clears.

04

THE SCHEDULE

Simple, up-front pricing – the same for everyone.

Published, so you can decide without another call. Nothing to haggle over, no surprises at close.

- **\$15,000 a quarter** — that is \$5,000 a month, billed quarterly in advance.
- **Every dollar credited at close.** The retainer is not a charge on top — it comes off the total.
- **No cliffs** — each dollar priced in its own band. A \$5M deal: \$210,000, or 4.2%.
- **Premium adds no second formula** — the retainer simply continues past close.

TRANSACTION VALUE	RATE
First \$1M	5%
\$1M – \$5M	4%
\$5M – \$10M	3%
Above \$10M	2%
Minimum fee	\$100,000

If the deal does not close there is no success fee – you pay the retainer and nothing else. The retainer is non-refundable, and every dollar of it comes off the fee at close. Every term spelled out plainly in the engagement letter. Same schedule for every client.

FOR THE ACQUIRER

Pick the engagement. We'll bring the function.

smbXCorpDev

Thesis to close.

smbXCorpDev Premium

Stays through the first hundred days and beyond.

One senior operator, on your side of the table, at a price you already know.

Book a call — smbx.ai



Paul Baker
150 acquisitions. Zero sell-side deals. Ever.

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